

# Attitudes, and Job Satisfaction

**ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR**

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**TWELFTH EDITION**

# Attitudes

## **Attitudes**

Evaluative statements or judgments concerning objects, people, or events.

### **Cognitive component**

The opinion or belief segment of an attitude.

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### **Affective Component**

The emotional or feeling segment of an attitude.

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### **Behavioral Component**

An intention to behave in a certain way toward someone or something.

# The Theory of Cognitive Dissonance

## Cognitive Dissonance

Any incompatibility between two or more attitudes or between behavior and attitudes.

### **Desire to reduce dissonance**

- Importance of elements creating dissonance
- Degree of individual influence over elements
- Rewards involved in dissonance

# Measuring the A-B Relationship

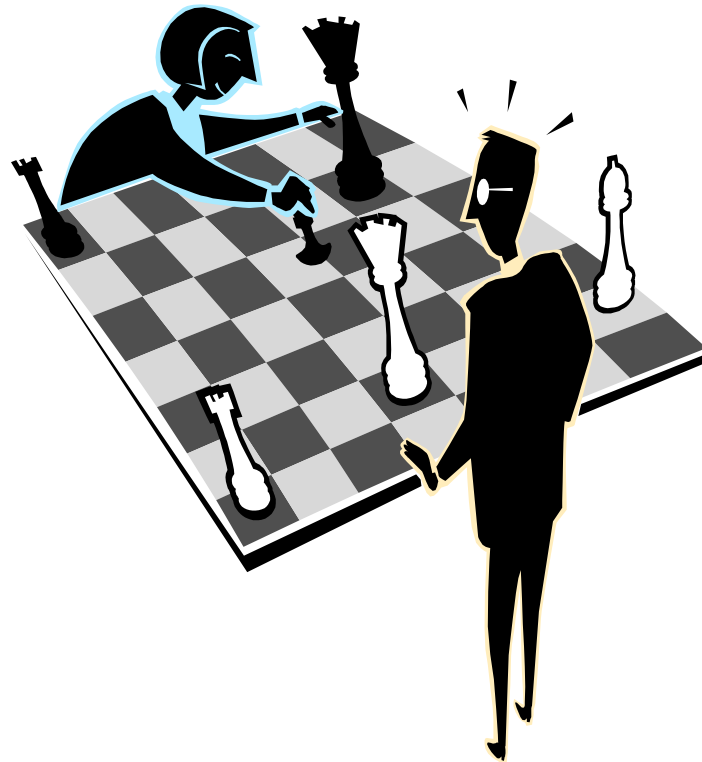
- **Recent research indicates that attitudes (A) significantly predict behaviors (B) when moderating variables are taken into account.**

## **Moderating Variables**

- **Importance of the attitude**
- **Specificity of the attitude**
- **Accessibility of the attitude**
- **Social pressures on the individual**
- **Direct experience with the attitude**

# Self-Perception Theory

**Attitudes are used after the fact to make sense out of an action that has already occurred.**



# Types of Attitudes

## **Job Satisfaction**

A collection of positive and/or negative feelings that an individual holds toward his or her job.

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## **Job Involvement**

Identifying with the job, actively participating in it, and considering performance important to self-worth.

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## **Organizational Commitment**

Identifying with a particular organization and its goals, and wishing to maintain membership in the organization.

# Types of Attitudes

## **Perceived Organizational Support (POS)**

Degree to which employees feel the organization cares about their well-being.

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## **Employee Engagement**

An individual's involvement with, satisfaction with, and enthusiasm for the organization.

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# An Application: Attitude Surveys

## Attitude Surveys

Eliciting responses from employees through questionnaires about how they feel about their jobs, work groups, supervisors, and the organization.



# Sample Attitude Survey

Please answer each of the following statements using the following rating scale:

- 5 = Strongly agree
- 4 = Agree
- 3 = Undecided
- 2 = Disagree
- 1 = Strongly disagree

| Statement                                                                   | Rating |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| 1. This company is a pretty good place to work.                             | _____  |
| 2. I can get ahead in this company if I make the effort.                    | _____  |
| 3. This company's wage rates are competitive with those of other companies. | _____  |
| 4. Employee promotion decisions are handled fairly.                         | _____  |
| 5. I understand the various fringe benefits the company offers.             | _____  |
| 6. My job makes the best use of my abilities.                               | _____  |
| 7. My workload is challenging but not burdensome.                           | _____  |
| 8. I have trust and confidence in my boss.                                  | _____  |
| 9. I feel free to tell my boss what I think.                                | _____  |
| 10. I know what my boss expects of me.                                      | _____  |

# Attitudes and Workforce Diversity

- **Training activities that can reshape employee attitudes concerning diversity:**
  - Participating in diversity training that provides for self-evaluation and group discussions.
  - Volunteer work in community and social service centers with individuals of diverse backgrounds.
  - Exploring print and visual media that recount and portray diversity issues.



# Job Satisfaction

## ➤ Measuring Job Satisfaction

- Single global rating (refer from a source )
- Summation score (refer from a source)

## ➤ How Satisfied Are People in Their Jobs?

- Job satisfaction declined to 50.4% in 2002
- Decline attributed to:
  - Pressures to increase productivity and meet tighter deadlines
  - Less control over work



# How Employees Can Express Dissatisfaction

## **Exit**

Behavior directed toward leaving the organization.

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## **Loyalty**

Passively waiting for conditions to improve.

## **Voice**

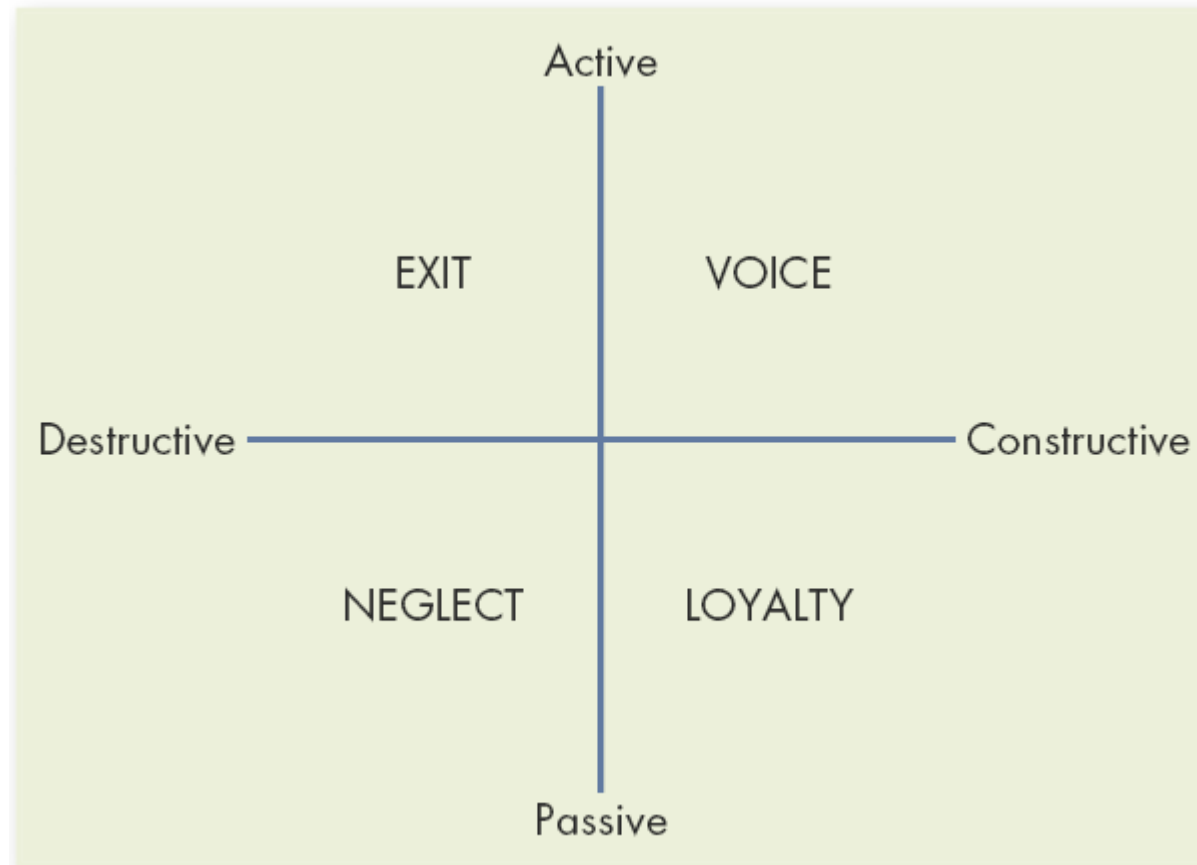
Active and constructive attempts to improve conditions.

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## **Neglect**

Allowing conditions to worsen.

# Responses to Job Dissatisfaction



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EXHIBIT 3-5

# The Effect of Job Satisfaction on Employee Performance

## ➤ **Satisfaction and Productivity**

- Satisfied workers aren't necessarily more productive.
- Worker productivity is higher in organizations with more satisfied workers.

## ➤ **Satisfaction and Absenteeism**

- Satisfied employees have fewer avoidable absences.

## ➤ **Satisfaction and Turnover**

- Satisfied employees are less likely to quit.
- Organizations take actions to retain high performers and to weed out lower performers.

# Job Satisfaction and OCB

- **Satisfaction and Organizational Citizenship Behavior (OCB)**
  - Satisfied employees who feel fairly treated by and are trusting of the organization are more willing to engage in behaviors that go beyond the normal expectations of their job.



# Job Satisfaction and Customer Satisfaction

- **Satisfied employees increase customer satisfaction because:**
  - They are more friendly, upbeat, and responsive.
  - They are less likely to turnover which helps build long-term customer relationships.
  - They are experienced.
- **Dissatisfied customers increase employee job dissatisfaction.**

